SHORT FILM · 1 BILLION FOLLOWERS SUMMIT AI FILM AWARD 2027

LOOK بُصّ

Four months after the crash that killed his wife and daughter, a man keeps them alive at home as two mannequins, until the memory he has been refusing returns one fragment at a time, and he finally looks at the last thing his daughter wanted to show him.

6:23	87	4 + 2	Story · Shot list · Assets
running time	shots	people + mannequins	Draft 1 · 11 November 2026

Story

Working title. Alternates: *Baba, Look* · *The Quiet Game* · *Table for Three*.

Logline

Four months after the crash that killed his wife and daughter, a man keeps them alive at home as two mannequins from his wife's sewing corner, until the memory he has been refusing returns one fragment at a time, and he finally looks at the last thing his daughter wanted to show him.

What the film is about

Denial is a refusal to look. So the whole film is built on one word.

The last thing his daughter said to him was **"Baba, look."** She was holding up a drawing. He turned to see it, and that second is the one he cannot forgive or remember. The mannequins have no eyes. The curtains are closed. A sealed hospital bag sits by the door, unopened, with the drawing inside.

The film ends when he looks: at the memory, at the drawing, at the plastic, and at the person knocking on his door.

The honest problem with this premise, and how we beat it

"Grieving man lives with mannequins, twist: they're dead" is a familiar shape. A jury will guess it within thirty seconds. Three decisions turn that into an advantage:

1. **We give the twist away at 0:30.** The mannequins are shown plainly, with no music sting. The audience stops asking *"what's going on?"* and starts asking *"what happened, and what is he not letting himself remember?"* That question carries six minutes. A twist carries ten seconds.
2. **The real reveal is small and human.** It is the one second he took his eyes off the road, because his daughter asked him to look at her drawing. He was a good father in that second. That is what makes it unbearable.
3. **The ending is an action, not a realisation.** Remembering is not the end. He opens the bag, he opens the curtains, he opens the door. "They're gone, Mona" is the first true sentence he says in the film.

Rules of the film

These keep it disciplined, and most of them make it easier to generate.

RULE	WHY
The mannequins never move on their own. He moves them.	It is the truth of the film, and static figures are the most reliable thing AI video can do.
We never hear them answer. He leaves pauses the length of a reply.	The silence does the acting. No lip-sync needed.
Her voice enters the present exactly once: "Baba, look."	One break of the rule, at 3:30, is the turn of the film.

RULE	WHY
Present = 4:3 frame, locked camera, closed curtains, cool and dusty.	He is boxed in.
Memory = full-width frame, handheld, golden hour, warm.	The past is more alive than the present.
The frame widens to full width when he opens the curtains.	The form pays off the story. It costs nothing: it is a crop in the edit.
Yellow is the only strong colour in the present: her dress, her cup, her sandal, her crayon, the sun in her drawing.	The eye always finds her.
He never eats. Three full plates, every meal.	Shows how long this has gone on without a caption.
No score until he breaks. Before that, only the clock, the radio and the room.	When music arrives it means something.
The crash is never shown. White, silence, a crayon rolling on asphalt.	Stronger than any impact, safe for any content rule, and avoids the physics AI gets wrong.
No readable text on screen.	AI text garbles, Arabic especially.
Each flashback is triggered by something physical: a click, a hair, a song, a light.	Trauma memory is sensory, not narrated.

Characters

- **Adam, 38.** A quiet man, an accountant type, gentle hands. A healed scar at his right temple that he touches when the flashes come. He is not mad and the film never treats him as a horror figure. He is a husband and father doing the only thing that lets him get through the day.
- **Layla, 34.** His wife. A dressmaker who worked from a corner of their living room. Warm, teasing, sings badly and knows it. We meet her only in memory. Her colour is burgundy.
- **Nour, 6.** Their daughter. Stubborn, bright, always drawing. Her name means "light". Her colour is yellow. We meet her only in memory, and hear her once in the present.
- **Mona, 45.** Layla's older sister. A voice through a door for most of the film; a face only in the last thirty seconds. Clearly related to Layla, clearly not her (older, grey in her hair, glasses).
- **The two mannequins.** Layla's display mannequins from the sewing corner: one adult, one child-size. Matte, smooth, abstract faces with no painted eyes. Adam has dressed them in Layla's cardigan and the dress she was still making for Nour.

The story, beat by beat

Cold open (0:00). Black. We hear a car, a crayon on paper, a child humming, a woman laughing, a seatbelt click. We do not know yet that this is the last minute of their lives.

Morning (0:06). A stove clicks on. A man sets a table for three, cuts toast into triangles, says good morning to two figures by the window. He tells his daughter to sit up straight and waits for her answer. He bends to kiss his wife's forehead, and we see plastic. He sits between two mannequins and talks through breakfast. He does not eat. The bin is full of other mornings. By the front door, under four months of unopened mail, sits a sealed hospital bag.

He buckles a yellow sandal onto a rigid foot. The click throws him somewhere else for two seconds: a seatbelt, a child's swinging legs. He shakes it off.

Hair (1:00). He carries his daughter to the sofa and tries to braid her hair. The wig slips. A flash: wind in a real girl's hair, a hand with a wedding ring tucking it back. He apologises to the mannequin.

The sewing corner (1:25). One shot explains everything: Layla's machine still threaded with yellow, the dress's missing sleeve under the needle, two empty stands.

The song and the dance (1:30). The radio finds an old song. A flash: the same song in the car, Layla singing along, laughing. He asks his wife to dance, and for a moment, cheek against the wig, he is at peace. Then her arm comes off in his hand. He kneels and puts it back, asking if he hurt her.

The knock (2:18). Someone at the door. Mona, Layla's sister, through the wood: *"It's been four months. I lost them too."* He does not open. He tells his daughter they are playing the quiet game. Mona leaves a dish of food and goes. For one second his face shows that part of him knows.

Dinner (2:46). The same table, at night. He promises them the sea tomorrow: *"This time we'll get there."* Headlights from the street slide across the two blank faces, and the memory hits harder: a windshield, lights, Layla's smile dropping. He ends the evening.

Bedtime (3:09). He tucks the child mannequin in, kisses her, switches off the lamp. In the doorway, in the dark, a child's voice says: *"Baba... look."* He does not turn around. *"Not now, habibti."* The voice comes again, brighter, and the road rushes in.

The road (3:39). The whole memory, in order, for the first time. Golden hour, the sea on the horizon, the song, Layla's hand on his. Nour in the back, drawing for an hour, refusing to show anyone. Then: *"Baba, look!"* He says one minute, he is driving. She insists. Layla laughs and tells him to look or she will never stop. He turns his head, and what he sees makes him happier than we have ever seen him. We do not see the drawing; the sun burns it out. Layla says his name. Headlights. White.

Silence. A yellow crayon rolls across asphalt. His open eye, cheek on the road, a sheet of paper drifting past.

The floor (4:37). The same eye, on his daughter's bedroom floor. He looks up at the bed: a plastic figure under a blanket. Nothing speaks. He cries, for the first time. Dawn comes.

The bag (4:59). He walks to the door and opens the bag he has stepped past for four months. Her watch, stopped. Her ring. A crayon. A folded sheet of paper. He unfolds it. *"I'm looking, habibti. I'm looking."* And we finally see it: three figures holding hands by the sea, under an enormous yellow sun.

Daylight (5:28). He opens the curtains, and the frame opens with them. In daylight the mannequins are objects. He takes off his wife's cardigan, folds it, breathes it in. He returns both figures to the sewing corner and lays the unfinished sleeve over the small one's shoulder.

The door (5:51). A knock, softer. This time he walks the whole length of the hall and opens it. Mona. He says it: *"They're gone, Mona."* She holds him in the doorway. On the table behind them, the drawing leans against a yellow cup.

Black. Title. A child humming five notes.

Dialogue (complete)

About twenty short lines. Recommended in Egyptian Arabic with English subtitles: it is specific, it is ours, and it stands out from a field of English-language AI films. This assumes a Cairo setting; the story works in any language, so change it if you prefer. Tune the Arabic by ear.

SHOT	WHO	LINE
05	Adam	Good morning, my loves.
06	Adam	Nour, sit up straight, habibti.
08	Adam	Mama's almost finished your dress.
14	Adam	...Where were we.
16	Adam	Mama does it better, I know. Don't tell her I said that.
20	Adam	Sorry. Sorry, habibti.
23	Adam	You always say I put too much salt.
26	Adam	Dance with me.
32	Adam	I'm sorry. I'm sorry. Did I hurt you?
35	Mona (O.S.)	Adam. I know you're in there. It's been four months... I lost them too.
36	Adam	Shh. We're playing the quiet game.
38	Adam	Who wants dinner?
39	Adam	Tomorrow we go to the sea. I promise. This time we'll get there.
44	Adam	...It's late. Bedtime.
47	Adam	Tomorrow, the sea. Sleep now.
49	Nour (O.S.)	Baba... look. — «بابا... بُصّ»
50	Adam / Nour	...Not now, habibti. / Baba, LOOK!
54–59	Layla, Adam, Nour	An hour she's been drawing. She won't show me. / What are you drawing, Nour? / Baba, look! / One minute, habibti. I'm driving. / Babaaa. Look! / Look at it, or she'll never stop.
62	Layla	Adam—
75	Adam	...I'm looking, habibti. I'm looking. — «أنا باصص يا حبيبتي»
84	Adam	They're gone, Mona. — «راحوا يا منى»

Most of Adam's lines can play on his back, his profile or off-screen, so lip-sync only has to be perfect on a handful of close-ups (06, 26, 50, 75, 84).

Sound and music

- **The 5-note tune** is the film's spine. Nour hums it in the cold open, Adam hums it off-key while cooking, the radio song is built on it, the score plays it when he breaks, and it completes for the first time over the drawing. The title card leaves it unfinished again.
- **The click**: seatbelt = stove igniter = sandal buckle = mannequin arm = hazard relay = night-light motor. One sound, six disguises.
- **The clock** ticks through every present-day scene except Nour's room.
- All music must be original. No existing songs.

Shot list

87 shots · running time 6:23 · limit 7:00, so 37 seconds of margin.

★ **Hero shot** (21). Generate these first and spend the retries here.

○ **Cuttable** (4 shots, 13s). Drop these first if time runs short.

Present: 4:3 frame, locked camera, closed curtains, cool. Yellow is the only strong colour.

Memory: full-width frame, handheld, golden hour, warm.

0 · COLD OPEN

0:00 – 0:06 · 6s · 1 shot

Black screen. The whole film is hidden in this sound.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
01	0:00	6s	**Black**	Black screen. No title.	—	Road hum. Wind through a cracked window. A crayon scratching paper. A child humming a 5-note tune. A woman's soft laugh. A seatbelt CLICK → hard cut.

1 · MORNING — kitchen / dining table

0:06 – 1:00 · 54s · 13 shots

A normal family breakfast. Hide the truth for 25 seconds, then show it plainly, with no music sting.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
02	0:06	4s	**ECU, macro**	A stove igniter clicks (the click lands on the cut). Blue flame catches under a small pot.	Locked.	Igniter click, gas hiss. A wall clock. Fridge hum.
03	0:10	5s	**Top shot, insert**	A man's hands lay three plates on a wooden table: two adult plates, one small plate. Three forks. A child's yellow plastic cup.	Locked, straight down.	Ceramic on wood. Clock.
04	0:15	5s	**MS, from behind**	ADAM at the counter, sleeves rolled, cutting the crusts off toast and slicing it into triangles. Curtains closed, glowing with daylight they keep out.	Locked, 50mm.	Knife on board. He hums the 5-note tune, slightly off.
05	0:20	6s	**Wide, through the kitchen doorway**	The dining table in the dim room. Two seated figures, backlit by the curtained window: silhouettes only. Adam enters frame with the plates and serves them.	Locked. Doorway as a frame within the frame.	**ADAM** **"Good morning, my loves."**
06	0:26	4s	**CU Adam**	First clear look at him: tired, gentle, unshaven, a healed scar at the right temple. He smiles at someone off-screen and waits, the way you wait for an answer. A small laugh, as if he got one.	Locked, 85mm.	**ADAM** **"Nour, sit up straight, habibti."** A pause the length of a reply. Only the clock.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
07 ★	0:30	5s	**Over-shoulder → CU**	He bends to kiss his wife's forehead. Focus racks from his lips to her: smooth matte plastic, a wig line, a seam at the neck. A mannequin in a burgundy cardigan.	Locked, slow rack focus. No push, no sting.	The kiss makes a small hollow sound. Clock.
08 ★	0:35	5s	**Wide frontal, symmetrical**	The tableau: Adam seated between two mannequins at breakfast. The adult in burgundy, the child-size one in an unfinished yellow dress (pins, white tacking thread, one sleeve missing). Three full plates. He does not eat.	Locked, 35mm, dead centre. Hold longer than is comfortable.	ADAM **"Mama's almost finished your dress."**
09 ○	0:40	3s	**Insert**	The kitchen bin as he scrapes a plate: layers of identical untouched toast triangles from other mornings.	Locked, top angle.	Scrape. Lid closes.
10	0:43	4s	**Insert, slow push-in**	The entry console by the front door: a pile of unopened mail, a dead plant, car keys, and a sealed clear hospital belongings bag, dusty, untouched. (No readable text anywhere.)	Very slow push-in, 50mm.	Clock, further away. A neighbour's door somewhere.
11	0:47	5s	**CU hands**	Adam kneels and fastens a small yellow sandal onto the child mannequin's rigid foot. The buckle closes.	Locked, low.	Buckle CLICK (same sound as the seatbelt).
12	0:52	2s	**ECU — FLASH 1**	A seatbelt tongue snapping into its buckle. A small hand. Golden light.	Handheld, macro.	The click, doubled. One beat of road hum.
13	0:54	2s	**CU — FLASH 1**	A child's legs swinging off a back seat, yellow sandals, crayons rolling on the upholstery.	Handheld.	A second of the child's hum. Cut dead.
14	0:56	4s	**CU Adam**	Still kneeling. Frozen, blinking. His fingers go to the scar. He shakes it off like a man waking up.	Locked.	Silence, then the clock returns. ADAM **"...Where were we."**

2 · HAIR — living room, late morning

1:00 – 1:25 · 25s · 6 shots

Care as routine. The first time the illusion physically slips.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
15	1:00	5s	**Wide**	Adam carries the child mannequin across the living room the way you carry a sleeping child: stiff legs sticking out, his hand cradling the head. He sets it on the sofa. The adult mannequin already sits in the armchair.	Locked, 35mm. Safer staged from behind him.	Footsteps. Plastic creak.
16	1:05	6s	**MCU, profile**	He brushes the child mannequin's wig and attempts a braid with clumsy fingers. A glance toward the armchair.	Locked, 85mm.	ADAM **"Mama does it better, I know. Don't tell her I said that."**
17	1:11	3s	**ECU**	The brush snags. The wig shifts sideways, exposing bare plastic scalp.	Locked, macro.	Bristles. A dry slide.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
18	1:14	3s	**CU — FLASH 2**	NOUR (6), real, eyes closed, laughing, wind from the car window whipping her hair. Sun flare.	Handheld, 28mm, close.	Wind roar, her laugh.
19 ○	1:17	3s	**CU — FLASH 2**	A woman's hand reaches back from the front seat and tucks the hair behind the girl's ear. A wedding ring catches the sun.	Handheld.	Wind. The radio, faint.
20	1:20	5s	**CU Adam**	His breath caught. Carefully, guiltily, he straightens the wig, smoothing it down with his palm.	Locked.	**ADAM** **"Sorry. Sorry, habibti."**

3 · THE SEWING CORNER

1:25 – 1:30 · 5s · 1 shot

One shot. Answers where the mannequins came from, and plants the ending.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
21	1:25	5s	**Wide, slow push-in**	LAYLA's sewing corner: a sewing machine still threaded with yellow thread, a pincushion, fabric rolls. The missing yellow sleeve lies under the needle. Two empty mannequin stands, clean circles in the dust where they stood.	Slow push-in toward the sleeve under the needle.	The clock. From the kitchen, a radio dial clicks on, static.

4 · THE SONG & THE DANCE — evening

1:30 – 2:18 · 48s · 11 shots

The happiest he gets, and the moment it breaks in his hands.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
22	1:30	4s	**Insert**	His hand tunes an old radio. Static resolves into a warm, old-fashioned song (original composition built on the 5-note tune).	Locked, macro.	Static → song.
23	1:34	5s	**MS**	Adam cooking, stirring a pot, swaying a little. The adult mannequin stands in the kitchen doorway where he has placed her, as if watching him.	Locked, 50mm.	**ADAM** **"You always say I put too much salt."**
24	1:39	3s	**Insert — FLASH 3**	The car radio. A woman's fingers turn the volume up on the same song.	Handheld, macro.	The song, brighter, through car speakers.
25 ★	1:42	4s	**CU — FLASH 3**	LAYLA, real, in profile in the passenger seat, golden light, singing along badly and laughing at herself. She turns to look at him. Our first clear view of her face.	Handheld, 35mm, from the driver's side.	Her voice over the song.
26	1:46	4s	**CU Adam**	A real smile, eyes wet. He wipes his hands on a cloth and holds one out toward the doorway.	Locked.	**ADAM** **"Dance with me."**

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
27 ★	1:50	8s	**Wide, living room**	He slow-dances with the mannequin in the lamplight, her rigid arm over his shoulder, his cheek against her wig. The child mannequin sits on the sofa, facing them. This is the poster.	Locked, 35mm, symmetrical. He turns; the camera does not.	The song, small, from the kitchen. His feet shuffling.
28	1:58	4s	**CU**	His face against the plastic cheek, eyes closed. Peace.	Locked, 85mm.	Song. His breathing.
29	2:02	3s	**Insert — FLASH 3**	Her hand resting on his on the gearshift, her thumb stroking his knuckle.	Handheld, macro.	Song through car speakers. Road hum.
30	2:05	3s	**CU**	The mannequin's arm slips out of its shoulder socket and slides down his back.	Locked.	A dry plastic pop.
31	2:08	4s	**Wide**	The arm hits the floor and rocks to a stop. He stands holding a one-armed mannequin. The song keeps playing.	Locked, same frame as the dance.	Hollow knock on the floor. Song, indifferent.
32 ★	2:12	6s	**MCU**	On his knees, he works the arm back into the socket, far too gently, far too fast. It clicks in. He holds the plastic hand against his forehead.	First camera instability in the present: a slight handheld breath.	ADAM **"I'm sorry. I'm sorry. Did I hurt you?"**

5 · THE KNOCK

2:18 – 2:46 · 28s · 6 shots

The outside world. The only other living person, and we only hear her.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
33	2:18	3s	**Insert**	The front door from inside. Three knocks shake the chain.	Locked.	Knocks. The song under them.
34	2:21	4s	**CU Adam**	He freezes, then reaches and turns the radio off.	Locked.	Song cuts. Total silence. Clock.
35	2:25	8s	**Wide, down the hallway**	Adam small and still in the middle of the hall. The front door at the far end, a line of landing light under it, the shadow of two feet.	Locked, 35mm, deep focus.	MONA (O.S., through the door) **"Adam. I know you're in there. It's been four months… I lost them too."**
36 ★	2:33	5s	**CU**	He crouches by the child mannequin on the sofa and puts a finger to his lips.	Locked, 85mm.	ADAM (whisper) **"Shh. We're playing the quiet game."**
37 ○	2:38	4s	**Insert, floor level**	The gap under the door: the shadow sets something down. A foil-covered dish slides into the light. The feet leave.	Locked, on the floor.	Foil crinkle. Footsteps down a stairwell.
38	2:42	4s	**CU Adam**	He listens to the steps fade. For one second his jaw trembles: somewhere, he knows. Then the mask comes back.	Locked.	ADAM **"Who wants dinner?"**

6 · DINNER & THE HEADLIGHTS — night

2:46 – 3:09 · 23s · 6 shots

A mirror of the breakfast tableau. The memory starts forcing its way in.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
39	2:46	6s	**Wide frontal, symmetrical**	Same frame as the breakfast tableau, now night, one pendant lamp. Steam rises off three plates. He talks; he does not eat.	Locked, identical to the breakfast wide.	**ADAM "Tomorrow we go to the sea. I promise. This time we'll get there."**
40	2:52	4s	**Insert**	He pours water into the yellow cup and keeps pouring. It overflows and spreads across the table. His eyes are somewhere else.	Locked.	Water. Far outside, a truck horn.
41 ★	2:56	4s	**Wide, side angle**	A vehicle passes in the street. Its headlights come through the gap in the curtains, sweep across the wall and slide over the two blank faces.	Locked. The light does all the moving.	Engine passing, low.
42	3:00	2s	**POV — FLASH 4**	Through a windshield: a desert road at dusk, oncoming headlights blooming.	Handheld.	Horn, rising.
43	3:02	2s	**CU — FLASH 4**	Layla's face turning toward the road, her smile dropping. Cut to white on the last frames.	Handheld.	Horn → cut to nothing.
44	3:04	5s	**CU Adam**	He is gripping the table edge. The cup is on its side, water running off the table. He looks at each of them.	Slight handheld breath.	Dripping. **ADAM "...It's late. Bedtime."**

7 · BEDTIME — Nour's room

3:09 – 3:39 · 30s · 6 shots

The quietest scene. The only time the present lets her voice in.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
45	3:09	5s	**Wide, through the doorway**	He carries the child mannequin down the dark hallway toward a room glowing with a star night-light.	Locked, behind him.	Footsteps. Dripping, fading.
46	3:14	6s	**MS**	He tucks her in, pulls the blanket up to the plastic chin and sets a stuffed rabbit beside her. Crayon scribbles taped to the wall (shapes only, no words).	Locked, 50mm.	Blanket. Night-light motor, a faint tick.
47	3:20	6s	**CU Adam, night-light on his face**	He kisses the forehead and stays there a moment too long. Stars drift slowly over his face.	Locked, 85mm.	**ADAM "Tomorrow, the sea. Sleep now."**
48	3:26	4s	**Wide**	He reaches the door and switches off the lamp. Only the stars remain. His silhouette in the doorway.	Locked.	Switch. Silence. No clock in this room.
49 ★	3:30	5s	**CU, profile in the doorway**	He is about to leave. He stops.	Locked. Do not cut to the bed.	Three seconds of nothing. Then, close and clear, a child's voice, the only time in the present: **NOUR (O.S.) "Baba... look."**

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
50 ★	3:35	4s	**CU face**	He does not turn around. His eyes fill.	Very slow push-in.	**ADAM (whisper)** **"...Not now, habibti."** **NOUR (brighter, car acoustics)** **"Baba, LOOK!"** Road hum swells → cut.

8 · THE ROAD — the full memory

3:39 – 4:37 · 58s · 16 shots

Full frame, handheld, warm. For the first time the fragments play in order and do not stop.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
51	3:39	5s	**Wide exterior, tracking**	A modest family sedan on a two-lane desert road at golden hour. A thin line of sea on the horizon. An inflatable swim ring pressed against the back window.	Tracking alongside, stable.	The song on the car radio. Road hum, warm.
52	3:44	4s	**Interior, from the back seat between the front seats**	Adam driving, Layla beside him, her hand on his. Sun low through the windshield.	Handheld, 24mm.	Layla singing along. He laughs at her.
53	3:48	4s	**CU Nour**	Back seat. Nour drawing with a yellow crayon, tongue between her teeth, the paper on a book on her knees. She hums the 5-note tune.	Handheld, 50mm.	Crayon on paper (the sound from the cold open).
54	3:52	4s	**CU Layla**	She looks back at Nour, then at Adam.	Handheld.	**LAYLA** **"An hour she's been drawing. She won't show me."**
55	3:56	3s	**CU, rear-view mirror**	Adam's eyes in the mirror, smiling.	Handheld, macro.	**ADAM** **"What are you drawing, Nour?"**
56	3:59	4s	**CU Nour**	She finishes with a flourish and holds the paper up. We see only its back, the sun glowing through it: shapes, nothing readable.	Handheld.	**NOUR** **"Baba, look!"**
57	4:03	4s	**MCU Adam**	Eyes on the road, the sun in them. He flips the visor down.	Handheld.	**ADAM** **"One minute, habibti. I'm driving."**
58	4:07	3s	**CU Nour**	Leaning forward against the seatbelt, the paper held higher.	Handheld.	**NOUR** **"Babaaa. Look!"**
59	4:10	3s	**CU Layla**	Laughing, touching his arm.	Handheld.	**LAYLA** **"Look at it, or she'll never stop."**
60 ★	4:13	5s	**CU Adam, slow motion**	He turns his head back. As he sees it, his face opens into pure joy. This is the happiest image in the film.	Handheld, slow motion, 50mm.	Sound drops to a muffled underwater hush. Only the 5-note hum stays clear.
61	4:18	3s	**His POV**	Nour beaming, holding the paper up, so backlit that the drawing is burned out by the sun. We still do not see it.	Handheld.	The hush.
62	4:21	2s	**CU Layla**	Her eyes go to the road. The smile falls.	Handheld.	**LAYLA** **"Adam—"**

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
63	4:23	2s	**Through the windshield**	Truck headlights filling the glass.	Handheld, shaking.	Horn, full.
64	4:25	3s	**White → black**	Pure white. Then black. No impact is shown.	—	Everything cuts to nothing. A thin high tone.
65 ★	4:28	5s	**Ground-level macro**	Asphalt at dusk. A yellow crayon rolls slowly across frame and stops against glittering crumbs of safety glass. Orange hazard light blinking, out of focus. No bodies, no blood.	Locked, on the ground.	The tone. A hazard relay ticking (the clock).
66 ★	4:33	4s	**ECU**	Adam's open eye, his cheek on the asphalt. Orange light blinking in it. A sheet of paper drifts past, out of focus.	Locked.	Tick. Tick. His breath.

9 · THE FLOOR — Nour's room, night to dawn

4:37 – 4:59 · 22s · 4 shots

The lie has nowhere left to stand. Back to 4:3.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
67 ★	4:37	6s	**ECU, match cut**	The same eye, the same angle, his cheek now on the bedroom floor. Night-light stars turning over his face.	Locked. Exact match to the asphalt framing.	The tick becomes the night-light motor.
68 ★	4:43	5s	**His POV, low angle**	The bed. Under the blanket, plainly, a child-size plastic figure with its wig askew. Nothing else. Nothing speaks.	Locked.	Silence.
69 ★	4:48	8s	**MS**	He pulls himself up against the bed and finally breaks: silent first, then with sound. The first real crying in the film. Hold it.	Locked, 50mm. No cut.	His voice. Score enters for the first time: the 5-note tune, single piano or oud notes.
70 ○	4:56	3s	**Wide**	The room. He has not moved. The window edge turns from blue to grey-gold.	Locked. Light change only.	Score, very thin. First birds.

10 · THE BAG — dawn, entry hall

4:59 – 5:28 · 29s · 6 shots

The thing he has walked past every day. He finally looks.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
71	4:59	4s	**Wide, hallway**	He walks slowly to the entry console.	Locked, the same hallway frame as the knock.	Bare feet. Score holds one note.
72	5:03	4s	**CU hands**	He lifts the sealed hospital bag out from under the mail. Dust slides off. He hesitates, then tears the seal.	Locked.	Plastic tearing.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
73	5:07	5s	**Top shot, insert**	The contents on the console: a woman's watch with a cracked face, stopped; a wedding ring; a stub of yellow crayon; a folded sheet of paper, creased and dirty.	Locked, straight down (echo of the three plates).	Objects on wood.
74	5:12	5s	**CU hands**	He unfolds the paper. Its back is to us.	Locked.	Paper. His breath.
75 ★	5:17	6s	**CU Adam**	His face as he sees it. Grief, and then, impossibly, a breath of a laugh.	Very slow push-in, 85mm.	**ADAM** **"...I'm looking, habibti. I'm looking."**
76 ★	5:23	5s	**Insert, full frame**	The drawing, in crayon: three figures holding hands, the smallest in the middle, a strip of blue sea, their little car, and a huge yellow sun. No words. (Use a real child's drawing, scanned.)	Slow drift.	Score: the tune completes for the first time.

11 · DAYLIGHT — morning

5:28 – 5:51 · 23s · 4 shots

The frame opens. The mannequins become objects again, and he lets them. From the curtain shot to the end, the present plays full width.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
77 ★	5:28	6s	**MS**	He drags the heavy curtains open. Daylight floods the living room for the first time, dust hanging in the beam. During this shot the frame widens from 4:3 to full width.	Locked. Aspect ratio opens over the shot.	Curtain rings. The street, alive: traffic, voices, a vendor.
78	5:34	5s	**Wide**	In hard daylight the two mannequins on the sofa are just objects in borrowed clothes. He stands looking at them.	Locked, 35mm.	Street sound. No score.
79	5:39	6s	**CU hands**	He unbuttons the burgundy cardigan from the adult mannequin, folds it and presses it to his face for one breath.	Locked.	Buttons. His breath in the wool.
80 ★	5:45	6s	**Wide, the sewing corner**	Both mannequins back on their stands, bare, except the child form still wearing the unfinished yellow dress. He lays the loose sleeve over its shoulder and steps back.	Locked, same frame as scene 3.	Score returns, warm.

12 · THE DOOR

5:51 – 6:16 · 25s · 5 shots

The theme, in one action: he lets someone in. Full width.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
81	5:51	3s	**Insert**	The front door. Three knocks, softer than last time.	Locked, same insert as scene 5.	Knocks.
82	5:54	5s	**Wide, down the hallway**	The hallway frame from the knock scene. This time he walks all the way to the door. His hand on the handle. One breath.	Locked.	Footsteps. Chain sliding.

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
83	5:59	5s	**Reverse, from the landing**	The door opens. MONA, mid-forties, holds a covered dish; yesterday's dish is still at her feet. She sees his face and understands before he speaks.	Locked, 50mm.	Stairwell echo.
84 ★	6:04	6s	**CU Adam**	He tries to speak and can't. Then he says it aloud for the first time.	Locked, 85mm.	**ADAM** **"They're gone, Mona."**
85 ★	6:10	6s	**Wide, from inside the apartment**	She steps in and holds him: two silhouettes in the bright doorway. In the soft foreground, on the table, the drawing propped against the yellow cup.	Locked. Hold, then cut to black on a breath.	Score, full, then out.

END

6:16 – 6:23 · 7s · 2 shots

#	IN	DUR	SHOT	PICTURE	CAMERA	SOUND & DIALOGUE
86	6:16	4s	**Title**	Black. Title: LOOK · بُصّ	—	Over black: the child's 5-note hum, alone, unfinished.
87	6:20	3s	**Credits card**	One card: credits, plus an AI-tools disclosure if the rules ask for one.	—	Silence.

Characters, locations & props

The next step after the story is locked. Build these as reference sheets before generating a single shot; every shot in `shot-list.md` draws on them.

Two looks

	PRESENT	MEMORY
Frame	4:3 (full width from shot 77 on)	Full width
Camera	Tripod, locked, slow push-ins only	Handheld, close, breathing
Lenses	35 / 50 / 85mm, deep-ish focus	24–50mm, shallow focus, flares
Light	Closed curtains, practical lamps, dusty window glow	Low sun, golden to dusk
Colour	Sage, grey, faded wood. Yellow is the only saturated colour.	Warm amber, skin tones alive, blue sea line
Texture	Still air, dust, stale	Wind, movement, lens dirt

Reference feel: naturalistic, photographic, 35mm film grain. Not glossy, not "AI cinematic". The apartment should look lived in by a real middle-class Cairo family, slightly dated, slightly cluttered.

Characters

ADAM, 38 (in almost every shot; the sheet that matters most)

- Egyptian, average build, slightly underweight now. Short dark hair going untidy, four months of not caring. Stubble, tired eyes, gentle face.
- **Healed scar at the right temple**, running into the hairline. Must be on every present-day close-up, and absent in the memory.
- Present wardrobe: one outfit for the whole film (it all happens in one day): a washed-out grey-blue shirt with rolled sleeves, dark trousers, bare feet or house slippers. Wedding ring on.
- Memory wardrobe: a clean light linen shirt, sunglasses pushed up on his head, shaved, healthier. He should look five years younger.
- Sheet needs: front / three-quarter / profile / back, neutral and crying, both wardrobes.

LAYLA, 34 (memory only; her face in 6 shots, her hands in 3)

- Warm, expressive face, laugh lines. Shoulder-length dark wavy hair, loose in the car wind.
- A **burgundy cardigan** over a light summer dress: the same cardigan the mannequin wears. Wedding ring, a slim wristwatch (the one in the bag).
- Sheet needs: profile from the driver's side (her main angle), three-quarter looking back, laughing, and the look to the road.

NOUR, 6 (memory only; 6 shots)

- Big dark eyes, a gap where a front tooth is missing, hair in two loose braids coming undone.

- A simple white summer top and shorts, **yellow sandals**. Not the yellow dress: that one was never finished.
- Always with the yellow crayon and the paper.
- Sheet needs: front, three-quarter, concentrating, beaming with the paper held up.

MONA, 45 (2 shots, plus her voice through the door)

- Layla's older sister: same eyes and mouth, but clearly older. Grey streaks, hair tied back or a loose headscarf, glasses, a plain dark dress. Tired, kind. The audience must never mistake her for Layla.

THE ADULT MANNEQUIN

- A boutique display mannequin: matte off-white, smooth **abstract face with sculpted nose and brow but no painted eyes or lips**, visible seams at neck, shoulders and wrists, slightly scuffed. Seated-capable (it sits at the table and in the armchair) and also stands.
- A shoulder-length dark wig, slightly cheap. Layla's burgundy cardigan, buttoned, over a plain dress.
- It must read as an object in every frame: rigid, hard, hollow.

THE CHILD MANNEQUIN

- Same family as the adult: matte off-white, abstract face, seams. Size of a six-year-old.
- A dark wig with two bad braids. The **unfinished yellow dress**: visible pins, white tacking stitches, one sleeve missing. One yellow sandal buckled on.

Locations

The apartment (one continuous set; build a floor plan and keep it) 1. **Kitchen**: small, older gas stove, a radio on the shelf, closed curtain over the window. 2. **Dining table**: beside a tall curtained window; a pendant lamp above. The symmetrical tableau frame (shots 08, 39) lives here. 3. **Living room**: sofa, armchair, a floor lamp, heavy curtains. Opens onto the sewing corner. 4. **Sewing corner**: machine, pincushion, fabric rolls, two mannequin stands. 5. **Hallway and entry**: long, narrow, front door at the far end with a chain; a console table beside it. 6. **Nour's room**: small bed, star-projector night-light, stuffed rabbit, crayon scribbles on the wall.

The car: a modest older family sedan, light interior. Build three fixed reference angles: from the back seat looking forward, driver's side looking at Layla, back seat on Nour.

The road: a two-lane desert highway toward the coast, low sun, a thin line of sea on the horizon.

The landing: a plain apartment stairwell outside the front door (one shot).

Props that carry the story

PROP	WHERE IT PAYS OFF
Three plates, three forks, the **yellow cup**	Opening, dinner, final frame
The **yellow sandal** with a buckle	Flash 1 trigger
Hairbrush, the child's wig	Flash 2 trigger
The old **radio**	Flash 3 trigger
The **sealed hospital bag** on the console	Planted at 0:43, opened at 5:03

PROP	WHERE IT PAYS OFF
Layla's **watch** (cracked, stopped) and **ring**	In the bag
The **yellow crayon**	Cold open sound, the road, the asphalt, the bag
The drawing	Never seen until 5:23
The **unfinished yellow dress** and its loose sleeve	Sewing corner, final sewing-corner frame
Stuffed rabbit, star night-light	Bedtime
The **foil-covered dish**	Left at 2:38, still at Mona's feet at 5:59

Make the drawing for real. Have a child draw it with crayons (three figures holding hands, sea, car, big yellow sun, no words), scan it, and use the scan for shot 76 and as the reference for every other appearance. It will be the most human thing in the film, and no model will draw it as well.

Where AI generation will fight us

RISK	PLAN
Mannequins "come alive": blinking, breathing, turning heads	Abstract eyeless faces; start every shot from a locked still; state that the figure is rigid and inanimate; reject any take with the slightest movement.
Adam physically handling a mannequin (carry 15, dance 27, arm 30–32, carry 45)	The hardest shots. Stage wide, from behind or in near-silhouette. Schedule them early so there is time for retries.
Face drift on Adam across 60+ shots	One locked sheet, one wardrobe, the scar as an anchor. Check every take against the sheet.
A child's face in close-up, consistent across 6 shots	Short takes, one lighting condition, the same three car angles.
On-screen text	None, anywhere. Blank labels, no phone screens, no captions in the image.
The 4:3 crop	Generate natively in 4:3 if the model offers it; otherwise compose centre-safe in 16:9 and crop in the edit.
Lip-sync	Most lines play off-screen, on backs or in profile. Only five close-ups need it.